Requesting a loaner laptop during repair

Article KB0010032 | Owner: Desktop Support | Subcategory: Laptop won't start | Applies to: Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840, MacBook Pro/Air, Windows 11 23H2/24H2, macOS 14/15

Summary

This article guides users and service-desk agents through the process of requesting a loaner laptop when a corporate device fails to start or boot correctly. It outlines self-help troubleshooting steps, the information agents need to collect, the Desktop Support workflow for issuing a loaner, and how to verify the replacement before closing the ticket.

Symptoms

- Laptop will not power on after pressing the power button
- Device powers on but remains stuck on the manufacturer/logo screen
- Boot proceeds to a black screen with a cursor or no display
- Windows repeatedly enters Automatic Repair loop
- Error messages such as "Preparing Automatic Repair", "Diagnosing your PC", "No bootable device found", or "BitLocker recovery key required" appear

Common causes

- Hardware failure - motherboard, power supply, RAM, or storage device
- Corrupted BIOS/UEFI firmware or failed firmware update
- Software issue - broken Windows update, driver conflict, or corrupted system files
- Power-related problems - drained battery, faulty AC adapter, or loose power connector
- BitLocker protection requiring recovery key after TPM or PIN change

Self-Help Troubleshooting

Before contacting the Service Desk, users can try a few basic steps that often resolve power-on or boot issues. These actions are safe, take only a few minutes, and do not require administrative privileges. If the laptop starts after any step, you can continue working normally and close the incident. If none of the steps help, proceed to gather the information listed in the next section and open a ticket via the self-service portal, phone extension 4357, or the Teams "IT Help" channel.

1. 1. Perform a hard reset (power drain):\n a. Disconnect the AC adapter and any peripherals (USB drives, docks, external monitors).\n b. Hold the power button for 15-20 seconds to discharge residual power.\n c. Reconnect the AC adapter (but leave the battery attached if it is removable).\n d. Press the power button normally and observe whether the system POSTs or shows the login screen.\n\n2. Check power source and connections:\n a. Verify the AC adapter LED is lit when plugged into a known-good outlet.\n b. Try a different power outlet or a spare AC adapter if available.\n c. Ensure the power cord is firmly seated in both the adapter and the laptop.\n\n3. Attempt a BIOS/UEFI recovery (Windows laptops only):\n a. Power off the laptop.\n b. Hold the <kbd>Fn</kbd> + <kbd>Esc</kbd> keys (or the vendor-specific key combo) while pressing the power button.\n c. Keep the keys held until the BIOS recovery screen appears, then follow the on-screen prompts to restore factory firmware.\n\n4. For MacBooks, reset the SMC and NVRAM/PRAM:\n a. Shut down the Mac.\n b. For SMC: hold <kbd>Shift</kbd> + <kbd>Control</kbd> + <kbd>Option</kbd> on the left side and the power button for 10 seconds, then release and press the power button to start.\n c. For NVRAM/PRAM: power on and immediately hold <kbd>Option</kbd> + <kbd>Command</kbd> + <kbd>P</kbd> + <kbd>R</kbd> for about 20 seconds, then release.\n\n5. If the laptop shows a BitLocker recovery screen, locate the recovery key in the Intune company portal (Devices ->?Your device ->?BitLocker recovery key) and enter it to unlock the drive.

Information to Collect for the Service Desk

When self-help does not resolve the issue, the Service Desk needs specific details to diagnose the problem quickly and determine whether a loaner laptop is warranted. Providing this information up front reduces back-and-forth and helps meet the P2 High resolution target of 8 hours.

1. 1. Device identification: asset tag or serial number, model (e.g., Dell Latitude 7440), and assigned user name.\n2. Exact symptom description: include any error messages, screenshots, or photos of the screen.\n3. Power-source status:

whether the AC adapter LED is on, if you tried a different outlet or adapter, and the result of the hard reset.\n4. Recent changes: any Windows updates installed in the last 48?hours, new software, docking station use, or physical impacts (drops, spills).\n5. BitLocker status: if prompted for a recovery key, note that you have retrieved it from the portal or that you need assistance.\n6. Impact: describe how the outage affects your work (e.g., unable to attend meetings, access critical applications).

Service Desk Procedure - Loaner Laptop Request

Desktop Support analysts follow this workflow when a ticket meets the criteria for a loaner device. The process aligns with the P2 High priority (8-hour target) and ensures that users receive a functional replacement while the faulty unit is sent for warranty repair or depot service.

1. 1. Ticket triage: confirm the issue falls under "Laptop won't start" category and that basic troubleshooting (hard reset, power check) has been attempted.\n2. Verify eligibility: the user must be an active Acme Global employee with a compliant device managed by Intune. Loaner laptops are drawn from the Desktop Support spare pool; availability is checked in the Asset Management system.\n3. Remote diagnostics (if possible):\n a. Attempt to connect via Intune Remote Help or TeamViewer (with user consent).\n b. Run hardware health checks (BIOS version, battery health, storage SMART status).\n c. If the device responds, collect logs for further analysis; otherwise proceed to loaner issuance.\n4. Issue a loaner laptop:\n a. Reserve a spare unit from the pool, record its asset tag, and assign it to the user in Intune.\n b. Ensure the loaner is enrolled, compliant, and has the latest Windows 11 (23H2/24H2) or macOS (14/15) build, BitLocker/FileVault enabled, and required corporate applications (Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, Company Portal).\n c. Prepare the loaner for handover: wipe any previous user data (if applicable), confirm the device charges, and include the power adapter.\n5. Communicate with the user:\n a. Provide pickup instructions (desktop support desk location, hours, ID badge requirement).\n b. Explain that the loaner is a temporary replacement and must be returned once the original device is repaired or replaced.\n c. Share the expected repair timeline (typically 3-5 business days for warranty service) and the SLA for returning the loaner (within 24?h of receiving the repaired unit).\n6. Create a repair order:\n a. Generate a warranty service request via the OEM portal (Dell/Lenovo/HP) or arrange depot shipment.\n b. Attach the ticket number, symptom description, and any collected logs.\n c. Set a reminder to follow up on repair status every 24?hours.\n7. Documentation: update the ticket with the loaner asset tag, handover timestamp, and repair order reference. Set the ticket status to "Waiting on Vendor" or "Pending Parts" as appropriate.

Verification and Closure

After the user receives the loaner and the original laptop is either repaired or deemed unrepairable, the Service Desk must verify that the loaner is functioning correctly and that the original device has been returned to inventory or disposed of per policy. This step ensures accurate asset tracking and closes the incident within the agreed SLA.

1. 1. Confirm user receipt: ask the user to reply to the ticket or post a confirmation in the Teams channel that the loaner laptop powers on, connects to Wi-Fi (ACME-Corp), and authenticates via Entra ID/MFA.\n2. Run a quick compliance check via Intune: verify device encryption status, latest security baseline, and that required apps are installed from Company Portal.\n3. If the original laptop is repaired:\n a. Upon return, inspect the device for physical damage and run a full hardware diagnostic.\n b. Re-image if necessary, re-assign to the original user, and retire the loaner back to the spare pool.\n c. Close the ticket with resolution "Laptop repaired; loaner returned."\n4. If the original laptop is deemed beyond economical repair:\n a. Initiate a disposal/scrap process according to Acme's asset-management policy.\n b. Retrieve the loaner from the user, re-image it for future use, and update the asset register.\n c. Close the ticket with resolution "Laptop replaced; loaner retained as permanent device."\n5. Final communication: send a closing email summarizing the outcome, any actions the user must take (e.g., return loaner by a specific date), and reminders about password policies and MFA.

When to escalate

If Desktop Support analysts determine that no loaner laptop is available in the spare pool, or if the repair estimate exceeds the 8-hour P2 target, the ticket should be escalated to the Desktop Support Team Lead (or the Asset Management lead) with the following details: user name, asset tag, symptom description, troubleshooting steps already performed, current spare-pool status, and expected repair timeline. The lead will either authorize an emergency purchase from the approved vendor, re-allocate a device from another site, or approve a temporary remote-work arrangement using a personal device with Intune enrollment and MFA.

Keywords: loaner laptop, laptop won't start, boot failure, black screen, automatic repair loop, hard reset, power drain, startup repair, motherboard fault, warranty repair, Desktop Support, Intune, BitLocker recovery key, MFA, self-service portal, phone extension 4357, Teams IT Help, P2 High, 8 hour SLA